algebraic expression

In algebra we use numerals, symbols and letters called variables or pronumerals, and combinations of both. They stand for the unknown values.

Examples

$\square + \square = 2\square$

$5 - x$

$a + b + c$

$x^2 - 2xy + y$

See coefficient, numeral, pronumeral, symbol, value, variable

algorithm

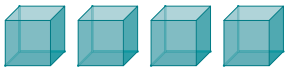
(algorism)

A rule for solving a problem in a certain number of steps. Every step is clearly described.

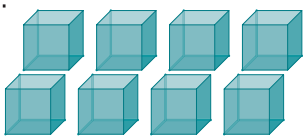
Example

Use blocks to find how many 3 × 4 is.

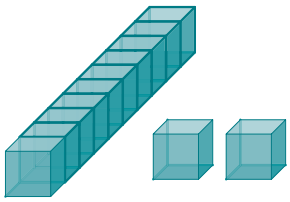
Step 1 Lay down one lot of four blocks.



Step 2 Put down the second and third lots of four.



Step 3 Exchange 10 units for one ten (long).



Step 4 Write down your answer.

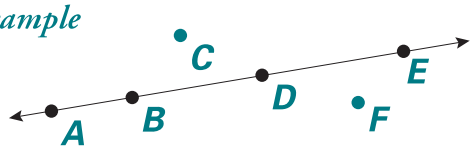
$3 \times 4 = 12$

See multibase arithmetic blocks (MAB)

align

Lay, place in a straight line.

Example



Points *A*, *B*, *D* and *E* are aligned; points ***C*** and ***F*** are not.

See line

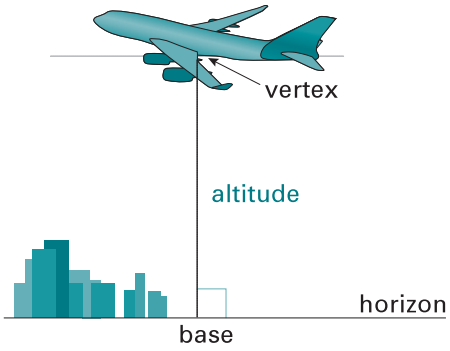
alternate angles

See parallel lines

altitude

Height. How high something is above the surface of the Earth, sea level or horizon. Altitude is the length of perpendicular height from base to vertex.

Example



The altitude of this aeroplane is 9000 metres.

See height, perpendicular, surface

a.m.

(ante meridiem)

The time from immediately after midnight until immediately before midday. The term a.m. is used only with 12-hour time.